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MONTEK SINGH AHLUWALIA

66, Deputy Chairman, Planning Commission

Plan Man

Because the prime minister has given him a carte blanche to turn the Planning Commission into a catalyst of change, helping the UPA Government achieve its targets.

Because "inclusive growth", the term he coined in his approach paper to the 11th Five-Year Plan, has become the prime minister's governance mantra.

Because he often works as the prime minister's personal ambassador, as when he was sent ahead of Manmohan Singh to the G-20 Summit on the financial crisis.

Because back home, he is seen as a pointer to the prime minister's mind.

Because he and wife Isher Judge are first friends at 3 Race Course Road.

Power attitude He wears his turban left to right, instead of the other way round. This doesn't, however, reflect his economics.

SUMET INDER SINGH/www.indiatodayimages.com

3

SAM PITRODA

67, Telecom and Technology Policymaker



E-ssential Voice

Because he advises the prime minister on public information, infrastructure and innovation.

Because Rahul Gandhi holds him in high esteem, seeking his opinion on e-governance, and hoping that Pitroda will usher in the "second stage of the telecom revolution".

Because almost all recommendations he made as chairman of the now defunct National Knowledge Commission are being implemented.

Did you know Pitroda sketches in his notebook during meetings, which he later puts on canvas.

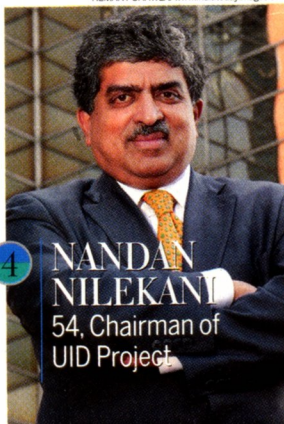
Card Crusader

Because he swapped a corporate life for Manmohan Singh's invitation to implement the ambitious unique identification card for all citizens.

Because the proposed technology advisory group to be set up under him will ensure better tax administration and financial governance.

Power read *The Last Days of the Incas* by Kim MacQuarrie.

HEMANT CHAWLA/www.indiatodayimages.com

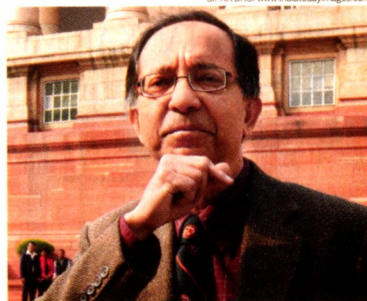


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NANDAN NILEKANI

54, Chairman of UID Project

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5

KAUSHIK BASU

57, Chief Economic Adviser

Free Radical

Because the former professor of economics at Cornell is the man Pranab Mukherjee turns to for advice on managing inflation and for giving shape to the Economic Survey and the Budget.

Because from rationalisation of subsidies to fiscal consolidation, from cutting bureaucratic sloth to plugging pilferage in anti-poverty programmes, he does not shy away from taking tough calls.

Did you know He likes to write plays and handpainted saris in his spare time.

6

R. CHIDAMBARAM

73, Principal Scientific Adviser to the Government

Vital Science

Because when the prime minister wants scientific counsel, he turns to the man whose office is spearheading initiatives like the setting up of the Rs 5,000-crore National Knowledge Network.

Because the man behind the Pokhran II nuclear tests could be the key to bringing academia in touch with industry through his mantra of directed basic research.

Did you know Despite the 1998 tests, when the US declared him persona non-grata, he was one of the key movers behind the Indo-US nuclear deal.

VIKRAM SHARMA/www.indiatodayimages.com

